



FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH (Oral Endorsement)

0500/23

Paper 2 Reading Passages (Extended)

October/November 2019

MARK SCHEME

Maximum Mark: 50

Published

This mark scheme is published as an aid to teachers and candidates, to indicate the requirements of the examination. It shows the basis on which Examiners were instructed to award marks. It does not indicate the details of the discussions that took place at an Examiners' meeting before marking began, which would have considered the acceptability of alternative answers.

Mark schemes should be read in conjunction with the question paper and the Principal Examiner Report for Teachers.

Cambridge International will not enter into discussions about these mark schemes.

Cambridge International is publishing the mark schemes for the October/November 2019 series for most Cambridge IGCSE™, Cambridge International A and AS Level components and some Cambridge O Level components.

This document consists of **14** printed pages.



Cambridge Assessment
International Education

Generic Marking Principles

These general marking principles must be applied by all examiners when marking candidate answers. They should be applied alongside the specific content of the mark scheme or generic level descriptors for a question. Each question paper and mark scheme will also comply with these marking principles.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 1:

Marks must be awarded in line with:

- the specific content of the mark scheme or the generic level descriptors for the question
- the specific skills defined in the mark scheme or in the generic level descriptors for the question
- the standard of response required by a candidate as exemplified by the standardisation scripts.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 2:

Marks awarded are always **whole marks** (not half marks, or other fractions).

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 3:

Marks must be awarded **positively**:

- marks are awarded for correct/valid answers, as defined in the mark scheme. However, credit is given for valid answers which go beyond the scope of the syllabus and mark scheme, referring to your Team Leader as appropriate
- marks are awarded when candidates clearly demonstrate what they know and can do
- marks are not deducted for errors
- marks are not deducted for omissions
- answers should only be judged on the quality of spelling, punctuation and grammar when these features are specifically assessed by the question as indicated by the mark scheme. The meaning, however, should be unambiguous.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 4:

Rules must be applied consistently, e.g. in situations where candidates have not followed instructions or in the application of generic level descriptors.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 5:

Marks should be awarded using the full range of marks defined in the mark scheme for the question (however, the use of the full mark range may be limited according to the quality of the candidate responses seen).

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 6:

Marks awarded are based solely on the requirements as defined in the mark scheme. Marks should not be awarded with grade thresholds or grade descriptors in mind.

Note: All Examiners are instructed that alternative correct answers and unexpected approaches in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the relevant knowledge and skills demonstrated. Nonetheless, the content must be clearly related to and derived from the passage.

Question 1

This question tests Reading Objectives R1 to R3 (15 marks):

R1 demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

R3 analyse, evaluate and develop facts, ideas and opinions

and writing assessment objectives W1 to W4 (5 marks):

W1 articulate experience and express what is thought, felt and imagined

W2 organise facts, ideas and opinions

W3 use a range of appropriate vocabulary

W4 use register appropriate to audience and context.

Question	Answer	Marks
1	You are one of the local press team. You are writing an article about tourism and mountain biking in the region, including the arrival of the well-known long-distance cyclist, Robert Costello. <u>Write the article.</u> In your article, you should explain: • what the region has to offer tourists • what the region's mountain biking entails • what Robert was worried about initially and how he overcame his worries. Base your article on what you have read in Passage A, but be careful to use your own words. Address each of the three bullet points. Begin your article: 'Our region offers so much to keep visitors happy ...' Write about 250 to 350 words. <u>Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 5 marks for the I am quality of your writing.</u>	20
	Use the Marking Criteria for Question 1 (Table A, Reading and Table B Writing) Notes on task Candidates should select ideas from the passage (see below) and develop them relevantly, supporting what they write with details from the passage and judging the appropriate register for the genre which is an article. Look for a clear and balanced response which covers the three areas of the question, is well sequenced, and is in the candidate's own words. Annotate A1 for references to what the region has to offer tourists Annotate A2 for references to what the region's mountain biking entails Annotate A3 for references to what Robert was worried about initially and how he overcame his worries.	

Question	Answer	Marks
1	Responses <i>might</i> use the following ideas: A1: what the region has to offer tourists • landscape / views (det. snow-capped mountains, large conifers) [dev. picturesque/serene] • eating out (det. many restaurants, healthy fine dining, healthy breakfast) [dev. renewing energy] • holiday accommodation (det. comfortable chalets) [dev. conveniently located] • all year round activities / range of different sports (det. skiing in winter months) [dev. instructors available to help you] • annual mountain bike carnival spectacle (det. thousands of riders to see) [dev. exciting, impressive, entertaining to watch] • socialising / camaraderie (det. evening gatherings, sharing stories from the day, rock music) [dev. make friends through sharing a common interest] • walks (det. evening, forests, paths) [dev. calm, relaxing once bikers have left] A2: what the region's mountain biking entails • high ascents (det. carrying bike, take chair lifts) [dev. bike is heavy so may be tired when you reach the top] • steep descents (det. starts immediately, caution at first, inching and slipping, fast speeds, sharp twists and turns, drop) [dev. adrenaline pumping, exhilaration] • infrastructure of area (det. network chair lifts, man-made tracks for the bikers, 80 kms of track) [dev. chair lifts used in winter for skiing; can hire or borrow equipment] • different runs for different abilities (det. categories for children, paraplegic, beginners and advanced) [dev. can choose] • carnival competition (det. receive prizes, watched / applauded by other bikers) [dev. feel proud, sense of achievement] A3: what Robert was worried about initially <u>and</u> how he overcame these worries • embarrassment / humiliation (det. knew he was a well-known cyclist / aware he is a public figure) [dev. out of his comfort zone, bravery] • lack of mountain biking experience / terror at going downhill (det. alien experience) [dev. had to learn a different set of skills, build up slowly] • injuries (det. painful) [dev. equipment and bike selected to minimise chance of injury, affect future cycling career] • Flora's role / view of Flora (det. absurdly young, expert) [dev. worried that she was not experienced enough for the job, skilled mountain biker, encouraging, dedicated] • wouldn't enjoy pure down-hilling / lesser version of the sport (det. heavy equipment more suited to motor-cross or speedway, cheating taking bike up on a chairlift) [dev. shared experience taught him it was enjoyable, realised value in building skills]	

Marking Criteria for Question 1**Table A, Reading:**

Use the following table to give a mark out of 15 for Reading.

Band 6: 13–15	- The response reveals a thorough reading of the passage. - Developed ideas are sustained and well related to the passage. - A wide range of ideas is applied. - There is supporting detail throughout, which is well integrated into the response, contributing to a strong sense of purpose and approach. - All three bullets are well covered. - A consistent and convincing voice is used.
Band 5: 10–12	- The response demonstrates a competent reading of the passage. - A good range of ideas is evident. - Some ideas are developed, but the ability to sustain them may not be consistent. - There is frequent, helpful supporting detail, contributing to a clear sense of purpose. - All three bullets are covered. - An appropriate voice is used.
Band 4: 7–9	- The passage has been read reasonably well. - A range of straightforward ideas is offered. - Opportunities for development are rarely taken. - Supporting detail is present but there may be some mechanical use of the passage. - There is uneven focus on the bullets. - The voice is plain.
Band 3: 4–6	- There is some evidence of general understanding of the main ideas, although the response may be thin or in places lack focus on the passage or the question. - Some brief, straightforward reference to the passage is made. - There may be some reliance on lifting from the text. - One of the bullets may not be addressed. - The voice might be inappropriate.
Band 2: 1–3	- The response is either very general, with little reference to the passage, or a reproduction of sections of the original. - Content is either insubstantial or unselective. - There is little realisation of the need to modify material from the passage.
Band 1: 0	There is very little or no relevance to the question or to the passage.

Table B, Writing: Structure and order, style of language:

Use the following table to give a mark out of 5 for Writing.

Band 6 5	• The language of the response sounds convincing and consistently appropriate. • Ideas are firmly expressed in a wide range of effective and / or interesting language. • Structure and sequence are sound throughout.
Band 5 4	• Language is mostly fluent and there is clarity of expression. • There is a sufficient range of vocabulary to express ideas with subtlety and precision. • The response is mainly well structured and well sequenced.
Band 4 3	• Language is clear but comparatively plain and / or factual, expressing little opinion. • Ideas are rarely extended, but explanations are adequate. • Some sections are quite well sequenced but there may be flaws in structure.
Band 3 2	• There may be some awkwardness of expression and some inconsistency of style. • Language is too limited to express shades of meaning. • There is structural weakness and there may be some copying from the passage.
Band 2 1	• Expression and structure lack clarity. • Language is weak and undeveloped. • There is very little attempt to explain ideas. • There may be frequent copying from the original.
Band 1 0	• The response cannot be understood.

Question 2

This question tests Reading Objective R4 (10 marks):

R4 demonstrate understanding of how writers achieve effects

Question	Answer	Marks
2	Re-read the descriptions of: (a) the mountain bikers, their equipment and their activities in paragraph 2, beginning ‘Downhill mountain biking ...’ (b) the sights in the region in paragraph 5, beginning ‘Basking in a mild ...’ Select <u>four</u> powerful words or phrases from each paragraph. Your choices should include imagery. Explain how each word or phrase is used effectively in the context. Write about 200 to 300 words. <u>Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer.</u>	10
	Notes on task This question is marked for understanding of ways in which the language used is effective. Relevant selections from each paragraph are listed on page 10. The notes on page 10 are a guide to what good responses might say about the selections, along with possible overviews which may be offered for each paragraph. Alternative acceptable explanations should be credited. Candidates can make any sensible comment, but only credit those that are relevant to the correct meanings of the words in the context. Credit comments on effects created by non-vocabulary choices such as grammar / syntax and punctuation devices. These must be additional to comments on vocabulary. Mark holistically for the overall quality of the response, not for the number of words chosen for discussion, bearing in mind that there should be a range of choices to demonstrate an understanding of how language works for the higher bands, and that this should include the ability to explain images.	

Question	Answer	Marks
2(a)	the mountain bikers, their equipment and their activities in paragraph 2, beginning ‘Downhill mountain biking has become ...’ <i>The general effect is of many devoted bikers going to great effort to enjoy an adrenalin-pumping experience which stays with them even into the night.</i> downhill aficionados: mountain biking devotees, passionate, slightly humorous lug: heave, drag with considerable effort lavishly suspended machines: extravagant levels of suspension, luxurious, overdone, no expense spared, complex technical design network (of chair lifts): complex system, connected, spreading out across area, coordinated, planned inching and slipping ... like cautious baby penguins (at the head of the ice skid) (image): careful, initially small, tentative movements; novice-like; a group of vulnerable figures huddled together, one taking confidence from another succumbing to the crazy dance of the drop: giving in / taken over; spontaneous / random / choreographed movements of sudden descent; madness of taking part manic speeds: ridiculously fast, insanely quick, loss of control punctuated by brake-juddering twists and turns: broken-up by very fast and frequent changes in direction; jarring, unpredictable, painful embroidered tales (of near catastrophe) (image): embellished stories, exaggerated claims, detailed and colourful, wanting to impress	

Question	Answer	Marks
2(b)	the sights in the region in paragraph 5, beginning ‘basking in a mild sense of accomplishment ...’ <i>The general effect is of the silent magnificence, stillness and dignity of nature – in striking contrast to the noisy chaos of the day.</i> bathed in the gentle violet hues of dusk (image): covered, surrounded with, soft early evening colours, comforting – striking contrast to the appearance in the day (the inclines, twists and drops took on a) softer presence: looked more inviting, less threatening (large, black conifer trees) crept noiselessly (image): number / size of trees growing on the mountainsides, moving silently, slowly and carefully, sneaking, not wishing to be noticed mild mockery (of the raucous day time chair lift users): humour at the expense of the mountain bikers who need the comfort and safety of chair lifts (snowy peaks) peeped (image): emerged, peered out, a slight or brief action modest affirmation: humble, unassuming confirmation, not boastful majestic beauty: impressive, spectacularly attractive, royalty, finery and magnificence	

Marking Criteria for Question 2**Table A, Reading: Language analysis:**

Use the following table to give a mark out of 10 for Reading.

Band 6: 9–10	• Wide ranging discussion of judiciously selected language with some high quality comments that add meaning and associations to words / phrases in both parts of the question, and demonstrate the writer's reasons for using them. • Tackles imagery with some precision and imagination. • There is clear evidence that the candidate understands how language works.
Band 5: 7–8	• Explanations are given of carefully selected words and phrases. • Explanations of meanings within the context of the passage are secure and effects are identified in both parts of the question. • Images are recognised as such and the response goes some way to explaining them. • There is some evidence that the candidate understands how language works.
Band 4: 5–6	• A satisfactory attempt is made to select appropriate words and phrases. • The response mostly gives meanings of words and any attempt to suggest and explain effects is basic or very general. • One half of the question may be better answered than the other.
Band 3: 3–4	• The response provides a mixture of appropriate choices and words that communicate less well. • The response may correctly identify linguistic devices but not explain why they are used. • Explanations may be few, general, slight or only partially effective. • They may repeat the language of the original or do not refer to specific words.
Band 2: 1–2	• The choice of words is sparse or rarely relevant. • Any comments are inappropriate and the response is very thin.
Band 1: 0	• The response does not relate to the question. • Inappropriate words and phrases are chosen or none are selected.

Question 3

This question tests reading assessment objectives R1, R2 and R5 *and* writing assessment objectives W2, W3 and W4:

R1 demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

R5 select for specific purposes

W2 organise facts, ideas and opinions

W3 use a range of appropriate vocabulary

W5 accurate use of spelling, punctuation and grammar

Question	Answer	Marks
3	How would a company operating balloon trips ensure that their trips were enjoyable and accessible to all their passengers, according to <u>Passage B</u>? You must <u>use continuous writing</u> (not note form) and <u>use your own words</u> as far as possible. Your summary should <u>not</u> be more than 250 words. <u>Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 5 marks for the quality of your writing.</u> INDICATIVE READING CONTENT Candidates may refer to any of the points below: 1. welcome a range of ages / plan for older passengers 2. access arrangements for anyone who may need assistance 3. attitude of staff: polite, attentive, sensitive 4. ample seating / enough seating, can sit with family and friends 5. arrangement of seating on all 4 sides 6. only fly if weather is suitable / postpone if unsuitable weather 7. minimise wait before getting into basket / inflate balloon quickly / ready to go in 10 minutes 8. provide safety briefings 9. range of trips / choice of trips / provide trips with views 10. online information beforehand: website, advert 11. organised (private) transport back to starting point (not taking bus or train) 12. track flight so aware of time and place of landing / met by ground crew 13. organise special occasion treats (e.g. cakes for birthdays) 14. commemorative flight certificates 15. can pay by instalments / allow customers to spread the cost	20

Marking criteria for Question 3**Table A, Reading:**

Use the following table to give a mark out of 15 for Reading.

Band 5 13–15	• A very effective response that demonstrates a thorough understanding of the requirements of the task. • Demonstrates understanding of a wide range of relevant ideas and is consistently well-focused. • Points are skilfully selected to demonstrate an overview.
Band 4 10–12	• An effective response that demonstrates a competent understanding of the requirements of the task. • Demonstrates understanding of a good range of relevant ideas with a clear focus. • Points are carefully selected, and there is some evidence of an overview.
Band 3 7–9	• A partially effective response that demonstrates a reasonable understanding of the requirements of the task. • Demonstrates understanding of ideas and is mostly focused. • Some evidence of selection of relevant ideas, but may include excess material.
Band 2 4–6	• A basic response that demonstrates some understanding of the requirements of the task. • Demonstrates general understanding of some relevant ideas. • There may be some indiscriminate selection of ideas.
Band 1 1–3	• A response that demonstrates a limited understanding of the task. • The response may be a simple list of unconnected ideas. • There is limited evidence of selection.
Band 0 0	• No creditable content.

Notes

Overview demonstrates a candidate's ability to summarise carefully selected key points in relation to the focus of the question rather than to paraphrase the passage. Candidates should give a focused response, drawing ideas from the passage provided; they should demonstrate clear understanding of both explicit and implicit meanings.

Table B, Writing:

Use the following table to give a mark out of 5 for Writing.

Band 3 4–5	• A relevant response that is expressed clearly, fluently and mostly with concision. • The response is well organised. • The response is in the candidate's own words (where appropriate), using a range of well-chosen vocabulary which clarifies meaning. • Spelling, punctuation and grammar are almost always accurate.
Band 2 2–3	• A relevant response that is generally expressed clearly, with some evidence of concision. • There may be some lapses in organisation. • The response is mainly expressed in the candidate's own words (where appropriate), but there may be reliance on the words of the passage. • There may be errors in spelling, punctuation and grammar but they do not impede communication.
Band 1 1	• A relevant response that lacks clarity and concision. • There may be excessively long explanations or the response may be very brief. • The response may include lifted sections. • Frequent errors of spelling, punctuation and grammar, which may occasionally impede communication.
Band 0 0	• No creditable content.

Notes

Mark holistically for writing using the mark grid above, using a 'best fit' approach.